CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

# PR SPECIALIST IN THE AI ERA

The pay is real. The door is the problem: everything a junior PR does in year one is the cheapest thing AI does.

**★ TL;DR — NO — for starting. BLS pay is verified ($74,750 median, May 2025), but growth is +2% and replacement-driven, and Microsoft's AI-applicability research scores this occupation 0.365 — inside the 40 most exposed jobs measured. Press releases, media lists and monitoring are the automated layer; relationships and crisis judgment are senior. The roadmap below is the way OUT: your communication brain sells better in rooms that are growing. ★**

## THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

OUR TAKE: NO — NOT IN 2027

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 6-12 months · AI RISK MEDIUM · CERTIFICATE

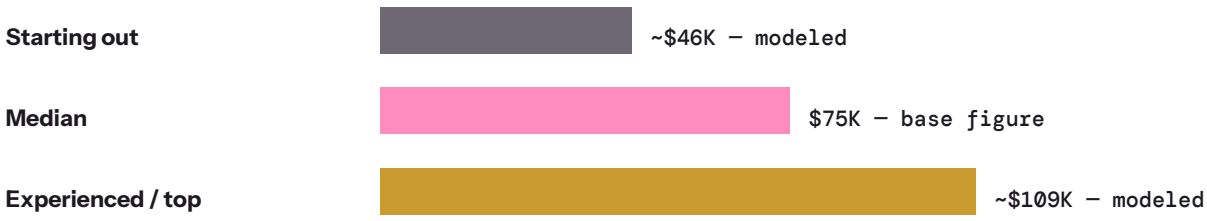
- Fails as a start because: the junior task list — release and pitch drafting, media-list building, coverage monitoring — is the exposed list, and the field's ~23,000 openings a year mostly replace people leaving, per BLS itself.

- The exposure problem: media and communication workers are the #1 most AI-applicable occupational group in Microsoft Research's 200,000-conversation study (group score 0.39), and PR Specialists sit in its top 40. Anthropic's labour-market research points the same way: slower hiring of younger workers in exposed fields.

- Still worth money: the trust layer. Journalist relationships, crisis judgment and counsel are real assets — they are just not sold to beginners. They are built sideways, from adjacent rooms.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

## THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS




The Career Glitch base figure for PR Specialist is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

## WHAT DOES A PR SPECIALIST ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Pitch stories to journalists, podcasts and outlets
- ✓ Write press releases, statements and talking points
- ✓ Manage crises: facts fast, tone right, on the record
- ✓ Track coverage and maintain media relationships

Think: a town crier with excellent contacts, hired the year every citizen got a loudspeaker — the contacts still matter, the crying is free.

## WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

| THE ROBOT | THE HUMAN |
|---|---|
| Press releases, pitch drafts, media-list building, monitoring, coverage reports, first-pass statements. The documented, cheapest-to-generate layer of communications work — and the whole first year of a PR job. | A journalist picking up your call because of the last five times you were straight with them. Crisis judgment under fire. Counsel a CEO trusts at 2 a.m. None of it is an entry product. |

⚠ **THE OPENINGS MIRAGE, AGAIN: ~23,000 openings a year sounds like a healthy field. BLS says most exist because people transfer out or retire. Entering a +2% field at its automated rung means competing with every experienced specialist the tools just made faster.**

## THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

| THE JOB IS | THE JOB IS NOT |
|---|---|

| | |
|---|---|
| ✓ People, stories and access — media rooms, launches, live moments<br>✓ Variety: no two weeks carry the same headline<br>✓ Writing and speaking skill compounds for a whole career | ✗ Not growing: +2% through 2035, and replacement-driven at that<br>✗ Not entry-safe: the junior layer is measured top-40 for AI exposure<br>✗ Not gatekept in your favor: no license, so nothing stops the flood of applicants |

Good fit? Already inside media, journalism or an agency with a live contact book — for you, PR is a sideways move with assets in hand, not a cold start.
Bad fit? Beginners whose plan is 'I write well and love media.' The writing is generated now; the love is not a credential; the door that remains is a relationship business with a years-long queue.

## THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

| DOOR A — PIVOT TO Corporate Trainer | DOOR B — PIVOT TO Market Researcher |
|---|---|
| The room where explaining pays and grows. BLS Training and Development Specialists: median $69,280, growth +11% — much faster than average — with ~46,000 openings a year (2025–35). The bridge is direct: PR people brief executives, rehearse spokespeople and turn dense material into lines a human can say under pressure. That is media training — a premium corporate-training niche you are already built for. AI can draft the course; it can't run the room, read the confusion and fix it live. First move: build one 30-minute media-briefing session for a founder you know and deliver it once. | The analyst side of the same curiosity. BLS Market Research Analysts and Marketing Specialists: median $78,760, growth +7% (2025–35). PR runs on reading audiences, coverage and sentiment — research formalizes exactly that instinct into the occupation businesses use to decide what to say before anyone says it. Your media fluency becomes the edge: you know which signals are real because you've watched them move coverage. First move: take one brand you follow and write a one-page audience-and-coverage read with three decisions it should change. |

Smart move: If you stay: get out of the drafting layer fast. Own a beat, a crisis specialty or a contact book so specific that your name is the asset — and enter from journalism or comms, where the relationships are built on salary.
Where you land after: You land where communication is the product and the field is growing — running the training room, or running the research everyone else quotes. The machine drafts for you there.

## YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ADMIT THE | INVENTORY YOUR | BUILD ONE | LEARN THE | GET A | APPLY FROM |

### STEP 1 — Admit the door, not the pay, is broken

FREE · TODAY

- Read the BLS page yourself: +2%, and the openings are replacements
- Your asset isn't the release — it's the briefing-and-reading brain. That's what moves

### STEP 2 — Inventory your transferable reps

FREE · 1 WEEK

- List every briefing, rehearsal, explainer or audience read you've ever run
- Pick the one session you could deliver tomorrow with no notes

### STEP 3 — Build one teachable asset

FREE · 2 WEEKS

- Turn it into a 30-minute session — or a one-page research read with decisions attached
- Deliver it once or send it to one real reader. Awkward counts

### STEP 4 — Learn the target room's toolkit

SELF-PACED · 2–3 WEEKS

- Trainer path: needs analysis, session design, measuring whether anyone learned
- Research path: survey logic, segmentation, turning coverage data into a decision

### STEP 5 — Get a live rep

FREE · 3–4 WEEKS

- Run one real session for a founder or team — or one real read for a real brand
- Capture proof: feedback, attendance, one decision that changed

### STEP 6 — Apply from strength

FREE · ONGOING

- Corporate trainer, training-specialist and market-research roles; lead with the asset and the proof
- Your PR past becomes the media-sense edge other candidates don't have

## FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

 Today: read the +2% and the exposure score yourself, then list your briefing reps. The second list is the career.

 Days 1–30: build the session or the research read; start the target room's fundamentals.

 Days 31–60: deliver one real rep for a real audience; collect feedback and a decision it changed.

 Days 61–90: apply to training and research roles with the asset and the proof in hand.

 Day 90: you're a communicator with a growing room to stand in — not a new pitcher at the back of a flat field's queue.

## NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

**★ OWN THE ROOM, NOT THE RELEASE ★**